MATTEO MARRALE

Junior QA Tester | Game Designer

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PROFILE

Junior QA Tester with Game Designer training, training at Digital Bros Game Academy in Milan (until summer 2027) and enrolled in the DBGA QA Testing course (from November 2026). Across 4 game projects I have written bug reports, organized playtest feedback and followed balancing to the final build. Game design helps me understand what a system should do before I test it. Two years in airport security at Malpensa taught me to follow strict procedures and notice details.

SKILLS

QA & Testing: bug reporting, playtesting, sorting feedback (incl. Google Forms), balancing & tuning, reading the GDD for expected behavior
Game Design: core mechanics, gameplay loop, level design, scoring & progression systems
Tools: Unity (URP, New Input System), Unreal Engine, Figma, Miro, ClickUp, Notion, Google Workspace, Microsoft Office, Git basics, Claude Code, Claude Cowork
Documentation: GDD, bug reports, playtest reports, pitch deck, technical design docs
Languages: Italian (native), English B1 (GDDs and dialogue written in English)

ACADEMIC PROJECTS — DIGITAL BROS GAME ACADEMY

Antiques: The Last Owner — *Narrative Designer & Writer* May–Jul 2026
First-person restoration simulator with supernatural elements, PC, Unity (URP). 6 in-game days, 3 ghosts, 6 objects to restore. Team 02 of 14, released 3 July 2026.

- Narrative design of the core concept (object → ghost → regret → ritual), with a "funny with a human undertone" tone, woven into the gameplay loop.
- Wrote two of the three ghosts (Eleanor, a Victorian lady, and Anselmo, a medieval soldier) and their in-game dialogue in English, with triggers, word counts and notes for programmers.
- Beat chart for the 6 days and tutorial texts (IT + EN) delivered diegetically: each day introduces a mechanic without text tutorials.

One Hell of a Casino — *Producer* Mar–Apr 2026
Hell-themed casual mobile game (Android): mini-game collection, gacha system and simulated monetization. Team 02 of 15.

- Coordinated a multidisciplinary team (4 designers, 5 programmers, 5 artists) over 6 weeks, through to release.
- Managed milestones (Alpha 29/03, Beta 10/04, Release 24/04) and cross-discipline dependencies.
- Created the feedback form (Google Forms) to collect testers' impressions of the beta.
- Delivered on time with Android APK, pitch, walkthrough, promo art and technical documentation.

Cosmic Chaos — *Game & Level Designer, Testing & Balancing* Feb 2026
Space Invaders reimagined with a "twist" mechanic and enemy spawn patterns. "Shuffle" format: the project moves to another team every 5 days. Team 03.

- Co-wrote the GDD with the team and designed the twist and the enemy spawn and movement patterns (several enemy types, differentiated scoring, blocking object).
- Testing, bug reports and balancing analysis (difficulty curve, usefulness of elements), with tuning up to the final build.
- Pickup-and-continue: took over work started by other teams and handed off my own clearly.

What a Train — *Game & Level Designer* Jan 2026
1-week game jam — theme "origin of music", side camera, 26-second run, at least 1 mandatory diversifier.

- From brainstorm to playable prototype in 5 days: designed an experience compressed into 26 seconds, prioritizing and cutting features.

The Hunger of Nigishida — *Game & Level Designer* Nov–Dec 2025
Snake-like arcade game set in Sumerian mythology: top-down, 3 levels, scoring and power-ups. Team 02 of 8, first Unity project.

- Game and level design for one of the 3 levels; co-designed the score system, items (Beer, Speed Potion) and NPC rules.
- After internal testing, collected the feedback into a list of 17 changes assigned to team members.
- Wrote the GDD in English (core loop, mechanics, NPC behavior, level design, UI/UX, audio spec), with the Sumerian theme throughout.

PERSONAL PROJECTS

Cat 'n' Hell! — *Personal project* Jul 2026 – present
Playable PC prototype; narrative and lore by Said Serbouti; I use Claude Code for programming.

- Playtested the prototype and listed bugs and fixes for the 1.0 demo (e.g. cleared waves restarting, boss fight triggering early).

Other Side — *Personal project* Sep 2026 – present
A first-person, turn-based dungeon crawler with permadeath, developed in Unity. You beat each enemy by using your items and the room around you. When you die, you start over: all you keep between runs is a journal you draw and write in yourself.

Fighting Ground — *Personal project* Oct 2026 – present
Hand-to-hand combat inspired by Sifu and a hex world map inspired by For The King; new moves are stolen from enemies' cyberdecks. Beat 'em Up Action RPG · Unreal Engine · combat prototype · working title.

All Bullets for Me — *Personal project* Oct 2026 – present
An FPS built on combining weapons and powers. Unreal Engine · early mechanic tests · working title.

EDUCATION

Digital Bros Game Academy — QA Testing online course (Plug-N-Learn, 60 hours) enrolled, starts 11 Nov 2026

Digital Bros Game Academy — Game Design course, Milan Oct 2025 – summer 2027 (ongoing)
Design documentation, Unity prototyping, level design, mobile game design, project management, Unreal Engine, advanced system design, game audio, AR/VR.

AIV — Accademia Italiana Videogiochi — Strategic Writing & Screenwriting (first year completed), Milan Sep 2023 – Jun 2024
Story structure, character development and narrative analysis applied to games, film and TV.

Vocational diploma in Industrial and Craft Production — IIS "A. Ponti", Gallarate (70/100) 2020 – 2022

OTHER WORK EXPERIENCE

Airport Security Officer — I-SEC, Milan Malpensa Airport (Jun 2023 – Jul 2025): security procedures, attention to detail, shift teamwork. School internships as a machine operator (2016–2017).

INTERESTS

Game design and critical analysis of games, narrative writing, comics, arthouse cinema, literature, philosophy, art history.

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